The first one is the most important: you've replaced your rails_helper (which loads the Rails environment) with an active_record_spec_helper (which only loads ActiveRecord). After that, since you're not loading Rails, you don't have access to Rails autoloading. As a result, you need to explicitly load the model files referenced in this test file—namely, Project and Task.

Let's take a closer look at active_record_spec_helper:

environment/01/spec/active_record_spec_helper.rb

```
Line 1  require "spec_helper"
-       require "active_record"
-       require "yaml"
-       require_relative "../app/models/application_record.rb"
5
-       connection_info = YAML.load_file("config/database.yml")["test"]
-       ActiveRecord::Base.establish_connection(connection_info)
-
-       RSpec.configure do |config|
10        config.around do |example|
-           ActiveRecord::Base.transaction do
-             example.run
-             raise ActiveRecord::Rollback
-           end
15        end
-       end
```

This code is based on Corey Haines's spec helper.[7]

First, a number of things are required. The critical part of this section is what is *not* there—specifically, loading the Rails config/environment, which brings in the entire Rails system. You're loading ActiveRecord and YAML.

The next two lines, starting with line 6, load your test database information from the Rails database.yml and then dig into ActiveRecord to set up a connection to that database. This will enable your tests to save to and read from the same database setup you've been using, but again, without loading the entire Rails stack.

Finally, on line 11, you have to handle database cleanup. RSpec has a global around method that takes a block and allows you to insert code both before and after each spec. In this case, you surround the spec with an ActiveRecord transaction, then execute the test with example.run, and then roll back the database to its pretest state. If you need more-sophisticated database management, look at the DatabaseCleaner gem.[8]

7. http://articles.coreyhaines.com/posts/active-record-spec-helper
8. https://github.com/DatabaseCleaner/database_cleaner